AUWA Website Specification — auwa.life

Created: April 2026. The specification for the auwa.life website — the brand's home and editorial hub. Load when building the website, planning content, or working on site structure. For implementation work (component tweaks, bug fixes, deploys), also load `context/website/patterns.md` *— they're a paired set.*

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1. Purpose & Positioning

The auwa.life website is the front door to the AUWA brand. It establishes AUWA as a Japanese lifestyle brand rooted in philosophical awareness before the app, store, or book exist as products. The website is the first thing anyone encounters — it needs to communicate the world, not just announce a product.

What it IS: A Kinfolk-inspired editorial destination. Atmospheric, contemplative, photography-led, with journal articles as the heartbeat. A place you visit to feel something, read something beautiful, and understand what AUWA is about.

What it is NOT: A product launch page. A teaser page with an email form. A feature list. A marketing funnel. It's a brand world — the kind of site you'd bookmark and return to.

Structural references:

- **Kinfolk** (kinfolk.com) — The gold standard. Serif typography, generous whitespace, atmospheric photography, editorial authority. The grid layout of articles creates a magazine-like feel that rewards browsing.
- **Cereal** (readcereal.com) — Minimal, travel-focused, serif-heavy. Beautiful article layouts with photography that breathes.
- **Monocle** (monocle.com) — Editorial worldview extended across products, retail, and media. Clean, confident, opinionated.
- **It's Nice That** (itsnicethat.com) — Design culture editorial. Clean grid, strong typography, content-led.
- **Mubi** (mubi.com) — Dark, cinematic, serif display type. Proves dark-mode editorial can feel premium and inviting.
- **Hoshinoya** (hoshinoya.com) — Japanese luxury hospitality. Atmospheric, slow, immersive. The photography integration and pacing.
- **Aesop** (aesop.com) — Restraint as luxury. Serif type, dark palette, every detail considered.

Additional references to study:

- **The Kinfolk Table** layout style — how Kinfolk handles food/culture/travel photography within article pages
- **Apartamento** (apartamentomagazine.com) — Raw, intimate editorial photography
- **Analogue Life** (analoguelife.com) — Japanese craft curation, beautiful product storytelling
- **Snow Peak** (snowpeak.com) — How a Japanese brand presents philosophy alongside products

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2. Site Architecture

All sections live under **auwa.life** with subpaths. All variants (auwalife.com, www.auwalife.com, www.auwa.life) 301 redirect to auwa.life. Google Search Console verified with sitemap submitted. Vercel project name: auwa-life.

```
auwa.life/                  → Home (editorial hub + brand introduction)
auwa.life/journal           → Journal index (all articles)
auwa.life/journal/[slug]    → Individual article (static-only: dynamicParams = false)
auwa.life/app               → Kokoro Mirror introduction (pre-launch: coming soon with email capture)
auwa.life/store             → Store introduction (pre-launch: coming soon with craftsman preview)
auwa.life/book              → The AUWA story universe (pre-launch: introduction + email capture)
auwa.life/about             → Tom & Rieko, the philosophy, the origin
auwa.life/brand             → Living style guide (noindex, disallowed in robots.txt)
auwa.life/not-found         → Branded 404 (src/app/not-found.tsx) — serves any unmatched URL
```

Noindex / disallowed routes: `/home-1` (archive of the flipbook hero), `/book/1`, `/book/2` (draft book-viewer mockups), `/brand`, `/instagram`, `/api/`. Each has both `robots: { index: false, follow: false }` in its `layout.tsx` (or page metadata for server routes) AND an entry in `src/app/robots.ts` disallow list. `/app/sitemap.ts` lists only the real public routes and the article slugs.

Information Architecture

Home is the editorial hub — not a static landing page but a living, updating page anchored by journal content. Think Kinfolk's homepage: a hero article, a curated grid of recent pieces, and subtle navigation into the four pillars.

Journal is the SEO engine and the content heartbeat. Long-form articles, craftsman profiles, seasonal essays, Japan travel stories. This is where brand authority accumulates and where organic search traffic lands.

App, Store, Book pages are initially lightweight — atmospheric introductions that establish what's coming, with email capture. They become full sections as each pillar launches.

About tells the story of Tom and Rieko, the philosophy of Yaoyorozu no Kami, and the origin of AUWA. Written in the brand voice: quiet, precise, present.

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3. Page Layouts

Home Page (Implemented)

The homepage leads with a full-bleed AUWA face video, then moves through editorial sections: an intro paragraph, two hero-scale pullquotes, a four-pillar tab module (desktop) / swipeable carousel (mobile), a Journal strip, the current micro-season, three pillar cards, a two-up article module, and the "Meet AUWA" video moment. All images use `rounded-xl`. Scroll is native across every browser — no smooth-scroll library. Page transitions crossfade between routes. The scroll-driven flipbook hero lives on at `/home-1` as an archive.

Structure (top to bottom):

1. **Header** — AUWA wordmark (inline SVG, `currentColor`) left-aligned. Navigation right: Journal, Store, App, Book, About. Transparent mode inferred from pathname (root `/` and `/home-1` only), otherwise solid white.

Sticky, hides on scroll down, reveals on scroll up. Rendered once in `layout.tsx` outside `PageTransition` so the logo and menu button sit above all page-leave animations.

2. **HeroVideo** — Full-bleed AUWA face video. `h-[100svh]` on every breakpoint so the video bottom pins to the browser bottom on desktop as well as mobile. Portrait `.mp4` on mobile, landscape on desktop. "Scroll" label + breathing vertical line replaces the bouncing chevron; the button calls native `window.scrollTo({ top, behavior: "smooth" })` with a header offset to land on the intro section.

3. **Intro block** — "Our philosophy" eyebrow, `ScrollFadeText` paragraph introducing AUWA and its four expressions, "The Story" CTA linking to `/journal/the-beginning`. Desktop-only 心 (Kokoro) watermark at 3% alpha behind the paragraph.

4. **Pullquote 1** — Hero-scale `ScrollFadeText` ("What you pay attention to...") at `clamp(2.25rem, 6vw, 4.75rem)`, leading 1.05.

5. **Four-pillar module** — Desktop (`md+`) renders `EditorialFrames` : a tab gallery that crossfades the active pillar's image (portrait 4:5, 480px column) with its editorial content (eyebrow, heading via `TextReveal` , body, CTA). Auto-advances every 7s, pauses on hover. Mobile (`<md`) renders `PillarParade` : horizontal overflow-x-auto row of four 3:4 cards with right-to-left reveal entrance (matches the Journal strip), dot indicators below. Both modules use the same heading ("Four ways in."). No scroll-hijacking; no sticky transforms.

6. **Journal strip** — 11 article cards in a horizontal scrolling row. Each card: 4:5 portrait image, rounded corners, category label, title, excerpt (55 chars max). FadeIn `variant="reveal"` cascade (60ms stagger).

7. **Micro-season** — 72 micro-season kanji display (`MicroSeasonFeature`). Breathing room either side. CtaLink "Read the essay" to the 72 Seasons article.

8. **Three pillar cards** — Book, Store, App. Portrait 4:5 aspect, rounded corners, gradient overlay with pillar name. Staggered cascade `variant="reveal"` (150ms stagger).

9. **Pullquote 2** — Hero-scale `ScrollFadeText` ("In every handmade bowl..."), matching pullquote 1 size.

10. **Two-up articles** — Onsen Lesson + Nozawa Fire Festival. Two large portrait cards side by side. Staggered cascade animation. "Read the essay" label has a text-roll rollover matching the nav.

11. **Meet AUWA video moment** — `VideoMoment` component. Portrait video of the AUWA character in a rounded card (left on desktop, stacked on mobile) with descriptive text alongside. Video and heading link to `/journal/the-beginning` . "The story behind AUWA" link goes to `/about` .

12. **Footer** — Dark (`bg-void`), sticky at bottom with parallax reveal effect (content slides over it as you scroll). "Quiet letters." newsletter signup, pillar links, copyright + social icons.

Archive: **`/home-1`** — The previous scroll-driven stacked-card flipbook hero (Obsidian Assembly pattern, `HeroFlipbook` component) is kept at this route for reference. The header treats it as transparent like root. Lessons learned there (mobile `svh` sticky, pixel-based transforms computed from captured viewport height, `activeIndexRef` -gated scroll state) are preserved in `hero-flipbook.tsx` and noted under Tailwind gotchas in CLAUDE.md.

Journal Index

Structure:

- Page title: "Journal" — rendered via `TextReveal` (same word-cascade entrance as the teaser H1s)
- Filter/category tags: Seasons, Craft, Philosophy, Travel (Instrument Sans, subtle)
- Article grid: Kinfolk-style cards, atmospheric photography, varied sizes
- Pagination or infinite scroll (start with pagination — cleaner, more intentional)

Journal Article Page (Implemented)

The most important page. Built with a content block system designed to map cleanly to Sanity CMS portable text.

Layout structure (top to bottom):

- **Hero** — Split layout: image left (4:5 portrait on mobile, fills viewport height on desktop), title + subtitle right-aligned
- **Meta row** — Category link, author/photographer credit (12px uppercase), social share icons (Facebook, Pinterest, X). Full-width border below.
- **Article body** — Content blocks grouped into layout sections by a `groupIntoSections()` algorithm:
  - **Text-only sections** — Text and pullquotes, always positioned on the right half (`md:ml-[50%]`). This alignment is consistent throughout the article.
  - **Image-beside sections** — Image on the left (4:5 portrait, with extra right padding to make it visually smaller), text on the right in a 50/50 grid. Text blocks that follow an image are automatically grouped beside it.
  - **Image-pair sections** — Two side-by-side images, full width, each with its own caption. Used for detail/close-up photography.
  - **Pullquotes** — EB Garamond (upright, never italic) at clamp(1.75rem, 3.5vw, 2.75rem), full opacity. Matches the homepage pullquote treatment; italic would break that consistency.
- **Full-width divider** — `border-void/8`
- **Continue reading** — 3 related article cards in a grid
- **Footer** — The shared footer component handles the newsletter signup ("Stay close.") and pillar links. No per-page newsletter section needed.

Content block types (maps to Sanity CMS):

```
type ContentBlock =
  | { type: "text"; text: string }
  | { type: "image"; src: string; alt: string; caption?: string }
  | { type: "image-pair"; images: [{ src, alt, caption? }, { src, alt, caption? }] }
  | { type: "pullquote"; text: string }
```

The order of content blocks in the CMS determines the article layout. No manual layout selection needed — the grouping algorithm handles it automatically.

Slide-up reveals — built into the renderer. Every `FadeIn` on the article page (text blocks, pullquotes, CTAs, image-pair sections, image-beside images, hero subtitle, byline) uses `translateY={32}` instead of the default 12. This gives article body content a deliberate slide-up as sections enter the viewport, rather than the subtler rise used elsewhere. Because the 32px translateY lives in `renderTextBlock` and the section wrappers (not individual article data), **every future article gets this automatically** — no per-article wiring needed. The article hero image uses `ImageFade` to fade in once the image actually loads, rather than sliding.

Teaser Pages (App, Store, Book — Pre-Launch)

All three teaser pages use the **same hero layout as the article page** — this was a deliberate choice after an earlier bespoke viewport-locked flex layout on teasers caused a visible content drop on desktop Safari (font-swap recalculation resized a flex-1 image column as custom fonts loaded). Using the article-page pattern eliminates the shift.

Structure (identical across app, store, book):

```
<main>
  <div className="grid grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-2 md:h-[calc(100dvh-5rem)]">
    <div className="flex flex-col justify-center px-6 md:px-12 lg:px-20 xl:px-28 py-16 md:py-0">
      <TextReveal as="h1" stagger={90}>{label}</TextReveal>
      <FadeIn delay={400}><p>{body}</p></FadeIn>
      <FadeIn delay={600}><SignupForm ... /></FadeIn>
    </div>
    <div className="relative aspect-[4/5] md:aspect-auto overflow-hidden order-first md:order-last'
      <ImageFade ... />
    </div>
  </div>
</main>
```

- Mobile: image with fixed aspect ratio on top, text block below (natural flow). No viewport-height constraint.
- md+: grid with viewport-minus-header height. Image and text side by side.
- `ImageFade` fades the image in once it actually loads.
- No Footer on teaser pages (single-viewport moments; footer would push content below the fold).

Content:

- **App:** "Awareness, daily." / body about daily practice / app-waitlist signup form / `/pillars/app.jpg`
- **Store:** "Lifetime objects." / body about craftsman objects / store-waitlist signup / `/pillars/store.jpg`
- **Book:** "Open the eyes." / body about illustrated stories / book-waitlist signup / `/pillars/book.jpg`

About Page

- Tom & Rieko's story (short, in brand voice, with photography)
- The philosophy of Yaoyorozu no Kami (accessible, not academic)
- The origin of AUWA (the name, the decade of development)
- The Eshi + Hanmoto model (brief, charming)
- Photography of Tom and Rieko (atmospheric, not corporate headshots)
- Title "The architecture / of Kokoro" uses two stacked `TextReveal` spans (second delayed 180ms) to preserve the explicit line break while keeping the word-cascade entrance

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4. Design System (Implemented)

The living reference for the built website. See also the brand page at auwa.life/brand for a visual style guide.

Typography (Locked)

- **Display + Editorial:** EB Garamond (400, 500, 600, 700; normal + italic) — `font-display` in Tailwind
- **Functional / UI:** Instrument Sans (400, 500, 600) — `font-sans` in Tailwind
- **Japanese:** Noto Sans JP (300, 400) — `font-jp` ; Noto Serif JP (400, 600) — `font-jp-serif`
- All loaded via `next/font/google` with `display: swap`

Type sizing rules:

- 12px — uppercase metadata labels (card categories, author credits). Tracking: 0.08em
- 13px — uppercase interactive labels (journal filters, micro-season link, image captions). Tracking: 0.06em
- 14px — all UI text (navigation, excerpts, form inputs, buttons, copyright). Tracking varies by context
- 18-19px — article body text (EB Garamond). Line-height: 1.85
- 18-20px — about page prose (EB Garamond). Line-height: 1.7
- 20-22px — card titles, pillar headings (EB Garamond). Tracking: 0.01em
- 28-32px — section headings ("Continue reading", "Stay close", "The name"). Tracking: 0.01em
- clamp(2.25rem, 5vw, 3.75rem) — page titles (h1) on Journal, About, and the three teaser pages. Tracking: 0.01em
- clamp(2.5rem, 5.5vw, 4.5rem) — article hero titles only (journal/[slug]). Tracking: 0.01em. Kept at the larger scale because the hero pairs with a full-height photograph and needs the extra weight.
- clamp(1.75rem, 3.5vw, 2.75rem) — pullquotes (EB Garamond, upright). Tracking: 0.005em. Pullquotes are never italic — in-article and homepage treatments match.
- clamp(3rem, 8vw, 6.5rem) — micro-season kanji (Noto Serif JP). Tracking: 0.06em

Form CTA buttons use `font-medium` (500 weight) across all pages. All other UI text is weight 400.

Colour (Light Theme)

The website uses a pure white background with the void/cosmic palette for text. This is the Kinfolk-inspired editorial expression of the brand — the dark palette lives in the app, social, and newsletter modules.

- **Page background:** Pure white — `oklch(1 0 0)` / `--color-surface`
- **Raised surfaces:** `oklch(0.95 0.005 250)` / `--color-surface-raised`
- **Text colour:** `--color-void` (`oklch(0.08 0.025 250)`) at opacity levels:
  - 100% — headings, titles, active nav
  - 80% — about page prose, footer category links
  - 70% — nav links, hover states, founder bios
  - 60% — subtitles, article subtitle
  - 50% — excerpts, captions
  - 45% — "Read the latest" arrow link
  - 40% — metadata labels, filter buttons (inactive), social share icons
  - 35% — input placeholder text
- **Borders:** void at 8% (dividers), 20% (form underlines), 50% (form focus)
- **Dark module (newsletter):** `bg-void` with white text at similar opacity levels

Spacing & Layout (Implemented)

Responsive horizontal padding (page-level gutter):

- Mobile: 24px (`px-6`)
- Tablet: 48px (`md:px-12`)
- Desktop: 80px (`lg:px-20`)
- XL: 112px (`xl:px-28`)

Vertical section spacing — three tokens, locked.

Every section on the site uses one of three utility classes defined as `@utility` in `globals.css`. No bespoke `py-xx` or `pb-xx` values anywhere. Changing a token in one place propagates across every page.

Why three? Because "consistent rhythm" means different things in different contexts. Two adjacent modules need a breathing gap between them. Paragraphs inside one essay need tight flow. Hero moments need generous airlocks. One token for each pattern, no overlap.

Token	Value	Use
`space-section`	`py-16 md:py-24` (64/96px, both sides)	**Discrete modules** — home page sections, journal grid, video moment. Two adjacent `space-section` sections produce a 192px gap between content, which reads as "distinct module to distinct module."
`space-flow`	`pb-16 md:pb-24` (64/96px, bottom only)	**Continuous narrative** — About page paragraphs, article byline, any columnar content that feels like parts of one essay. Sections flow with a single 96px gap, not doubled.
`space-breathing`	`py-28 md:py-44` (112/176px, both sides)	**Hero moments** — pullquotes and the 72 micro-seasons kanji module. Content that needs to stand alone and inhale.

How to pick. Ask: is this section an independent module, or a paragraph in a continuous narrative? Home page sections are independent (each has its own identity) → `space-section`. About page paragraphs are narrative (they flow as one essay) → `space-flow`. Pullquotes and the kanji moment are hero content → `space-breathing`.

Exceptions — the complete list. These are the only places we deviate from the three tokens. If you need something outside this list, promote the new exception into this table before writing it in code.

- Hero top padding: `pt-12 md:pt-16` (48/64px) — for page heroes that use `space-flow` and need a tighter top to sit close to the header (e.g. About page hero).
- Header height: `h-16 md:h-20` (64/80px)
- Newsletter (footer): lives inside `footer.tsx` — the footer has its own internal rhythm and doesn't use any section token.

Any page-section `<section>` in `src/app/**/page.tsx` or `src/components/*.tsx` MUST use `space-section`, `space-flow`, or `space-breathing`. Hardcoded `py-20`, `pb-32`, etc. are drift — treat as bugs.

Separator placement — always between sections, never inline.

The `<Separator />` component is a zero-padding, full-width divider line. It sits at the exact boundary between two sections, taking no vertical space of its own. The symmetry rule: each adjacent section's padding token provides the breathing room on its own side, so a `space-section → Separator → space-section` boundary reads as 96px above the line and 96px below on desktop.

NEVER place a divider line inline at the top of a section (inside its top padding) — that pushes the line *into* the section's padding, making the space above the line smaller than the space below and breaking symmetry with other separators on the page. If you need a divider between sections, render `<Separator />` between them in the page tree. If the previous section flows straight into the next without a line, skip the separator entirely.

Trailing spacer before the footer. The last module on any page needs a `<div className="h-16 md:h-24" aria-hidden="true" />` before `</main>`. Between adjacent sections mid-page the total gap is 96+96 = 192px (two space-section padding blocks meeting); the trailing spacer recreates that gap against the footer, so the last module doesn't sit tighter to the footer than it does to the module above it.

Grid gaps:

- Article grid (journal index): `gap-x-6 md:gap-x-8 gap-y-12 md:gap-y-16`
- Pillar cards (home): `gap-5 md:gap-6 lg:gap-8`
- Horizontal scroll (home): `gap-5 md:gap-6 lg:gap-8`
- Image pairs (article): `gap-4 md:gap-6`
- Founder bios (about): `gap-8 md:gap-16`

Content widths:

- Article body text: right half of viewport (`md:ml-[50%]`)
- About page prose: `max-w-[680px]` centred
- Newsletter form: `max-w-[400px]` centred within `max-w-[480px]` container
- Waitlist forms: `max-w-[440px]`
- Horizontal scroll cards: `w-[260px] md:w-[280px] lg:w-[300px]`

Image aspect ratios:

- Primary (cards, articles, editorial): 4:5 portrait — the standard ratio everywhere
- Book cover: 3:4 portrait
- Image break (about page): 2.5:1 landscape
- Article hero (mobile): 4:5 portrait; (desktop): fills viewport height

Motion (Locked tokens)

Every animation on the site consumes the same tokens. CSS durations live in `globals.css` (`--duration-*`); JS durations, staggers, and easing live in `src/lib/motion.ts` (`DURATION` , `STAGGER` , `EASING`). Components import from `motion.ts` instead of hardcoding ms values. Changing a token in one place propagates everywhere — FadeIn, TextReveal, hover states, page transitions, the lot.

Durations (single source of truth — `motion.ts` + `globals.css`):

Token	Value	Use
`DURATION.enter` / `--duration-enter`	800ms	FadeIn default, TextReveal — text and general reveals
`DURATION.reveal` / `--duration-reveal`	1200ms	FadeIn reveal variant — image cards, visual moments
`DURATION.hover` / `--duration-hover`	300ms	Hover and state transitions
`DURATION.page` / `--duration-page`	500ms	PageTransition crossfade

Stagger ladder — three values, no ad-hoc numbers:

Token	Value	Use
`STAGGER.strip`	60ms	Horizontal scrollers (Journal strip, PillarParade)
`STAGGER.grid`	120ms	Grid cascades (pillar cards, continue reading, two-up articles)
`STAGGER.hero`	180ms	Display-type cascades (multi-line TextReveal, stacked hero headings)

Easing — three curves only:

Token	Value	Use
`EASING.outExpo` / `--ease-out-expo` / Tailwind `ease-out-expo`	`cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1)`	Brand default — fast departure, gentle arrival. "Like a breath out."
`EASING.inOut` / `--ease-in-out` / Tailwind `ease-in-out`	`cubic-bezier(0.65, 0, 0.35, 1)`	Symmetric — image crossfades, slow ambient transitions
`EASING.textRoll` / `--ease-text-roll` / Tailwind `ease-text-roll`	`cubic-bezier(0.7, 0, 0.3, 1)`	Text-roll hover rollovers (CTAs, nav items, scroll label) — punchier "snap into place" feel, sharper than outExpo

FadeIn mechanics (fixed):

- `variant="fade"` (default): 12px rise, `DURATION.enter`
- `variant="reveal"` : 24px rise, `DURATION.reveal`
- Root margin: `"0px 0px -40px 0px"` (fires 40px before viewport edge); extended to `"0px 200% 0px 0px"` for horizontal scrollers so off-viewport-right cards fire when the section scrolls in
- No `will-change` toggling (Safari layer-teardown jitter — see `website-patterns.md`)

Hardcoded ms values are drift. If you see `duration-500` , `800ms` , or `delay={150}` in a component, it should come from `motion.ts` instead. Treat as a bug.

Photography Treatment

All photography follows brand.md Section 6. Portrait-first (4:5) for all editorial and card imagery — no landscape images in article layouts or grids.

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5. Technical Architecture

Stack

- **Framework:** Next.js 15 (App Router, React Server Components, webpack)
- **Styling:** Tailwind CSS 4 (PostCSS plugin, OKLCH colour system via `@theme inline` in globals.css)
- **CMS:** Sanity (headless — not yet integrated; content currently hardcoded as placeholder data)
- **Hosting:** Vercel (automatic deployments, edge functions, image optimisation)
- **Email:** Resend (fully integrated — welcome emails auto-send on signup, newsletter sends via API). Templates in `src/emails/` using React Email (`@react-email/components`).

- **Analytics:** Vercel Analytics (`@vercel/analytics/react` , added to `layout.tsx`). Privacy-respecting, no cookie banner needed, GDPR compliant.
- **Fonts:** Google Fonts via next/font (EB Garamond, Instrument Sans, Noto Sans JP, Noto Serif JP)

Sanity Content Model

```
// Journal Article
{
  title: string
  slug: slug
  publishedAt: datetime
  category: reference → Category
  heroImage: image (with hotspot)
  excerpt: text
  body: portable text (rich text with images, pull quotes, embeds)
  author: reference → Author
  seoTitle: string
  seoDescription: text
  relatedArticles: array of references → Article
}

// Category
{
  title: string  // Seasons, Craft, Travel, Philosophy
  slug: slug
  description: text
}

// Author
{
  name: string
  role: string
  image: image
  bio: text
}

// Page (for App, Store, Book, About — editable)
{
  title: string
  slug: slug
  heroImage: image
  body: portable text
  seoTitle: string
  seoDescription: text
}
```

```
// Newsletter subscribers are handled directly via Resend Contacts API.
// No Sanity schema needed. See context/marketing/newsletter.md for details.
```

Image Pipeline

- Sanity's image CDN handles responsive sizing, format conversion (WebP/AVIF), and cropping
- All images uploaded at 2x resolution minimum (2400px wide for full-width heroes)
- Hotspot cropping set in Sanity Studio for each image (ensures correct focal point across aspect ratios)
- Lazy loading for below-fold images (Next.js Image component handles this)
- Target: 95+ Lighthouse performance score

Component Library

Reusable components live in `src/components/`. All are server components unless noted.

Component	File	Client?	Purpose
Header	`header.tsx`	Yes	Rendered once in `layout.tsx` (outside `PageTransition`) so the logo + menu button stay above page-leave animations. `transparent` mode inferred from pathname (`/` only). Mobile menu is portalled to body. Morphing hamburger→X via inline-style transitions. Logo fades out when menu opens.
Footer	`footer.tsx`	No	"Stay close" newsletter signup (dark), pillar links, copyright + social icons. Sticky at bottom with parallax reveal.
SignupForm	`signup-form.tsx`	Yes	Email signup form. Props: `source` (app-waitlist / store-waitlist / book-waitlist / newsletter), `buttonText`, `successMessage`, `theme` (light/dark), `className`. Posts to `/api/signup`. Input, button, and success message all use `text-[16px]` (not 14px) to prevent iOS Safari's focus auto-zoom — anything under 16px fires the zoom, which pushed the submit button off-screen on smaller iPhones.
FadeIn	`fade-in.tsx`	Yes	IntersectionObserver-based animation. Two variants: `"fade"` (default, 12px rise) and `"reveal"` (slides in from the right, for image cards). Accepts `className`, `delay`, `duration`, `translateY`, `variant`. Article pages pass `translateY={32}` for a more pronounced slide-up on body content.
StripReveal	`strip-reveal.tsx`	Yes	Module-level reveal for horizontal scrollers. One IntersectionObserver fires when the container enters viewport and cascades all children in with CSS transition-delay stagger. Replaces per-card FadeIn in horizontal scrollers — the per-card approach fails on narrow viewports (rootMargin 200% only catches the first ~3 cards). After first reveal, swiping right shows already-revealed cards. Props: `className`, `itemClassName`, `stagger`, `translateX`.
TextReveal	`text-reveal.tsx`	Yes	Word-by-word text animation. Splits text into words, each rises from below with stagger. For hero headlines. Props: `as` (tag), `delay`, `stagger`. Used on teaser H1s ("Open the eyes.", "Awareness, daily.", "Lifetime objects.") and on the Journal + About page titles. For explicit multi-line headings (e.g. About's "The architecture / of

			Kokoro"), stack two TextReveal spans with `as="span" className="block"` and `delay={180}` on the second so the cascade flows from line 1 into line 2.
PageTransition	`page-transition.tsx`	Yes	Opacity-only crossfade on route change (500ms). Wraps children in layout.tsx. No transform — an earlier version translated content 18px down on enter, which caused a visible drop on teaser pages (viewport-locked layouts expose any page-wrapper translate; article pages absorbed it via natural flow). Opacity-only keeps the handoff smooth on every page.
HeroVideo	`hero-video.tsx`	Yes	Full-bleed video hero for the live homepage. `h-[100svh]` on all viewports (no desktop aspect cap), so the video bottom pins to the browser bottom whatever the monitor ratio. Portrait `.mp4` on mobile, landscape on desktop. "Scroll" label + breathing vertical line is a `<button>` that calls native `window.scrollTo({ top, behavior: "smooth" })` with a header offset to land on the intro.
EditorialFrames	`editorial-frames.tsx`	Yes	Desktop (≥md) four-pillar module. Tab gallery crossfading through four frames (Store / Book / Journal / App) with staggered reveal per frame (eyebrow → `TextReveal` heading → body → CTA). Image column pinned at 480px, text column flexible, grid template `[480px_1fr]`, `lg:gap-28` horizontal gap, `max-w-[1100px] lg:mx-auto`. Auto-advance every 7s, pauses on hover. Image crossfade: 1500ms `cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1)` (symmetric ease-in-out, gentle).
PillarParade	`pillar-parade.tsx`	Yes	Mobile (<md) four-pillar module. Horizontal `overflow-x-auto` row of four 3:4 cards mirroring the Journal strip (native scroll, no snap, no `touch-action` override). Cards at `w-[72vw] max-w-[360px]` so card 2 peeks clearly. FadeIn `variant="reveal"` with `revealDistance={40}` so the right-to-left cascade matches the Journal strip without pushing card 2 below the IntersectionObserver's 10% threshold. Dot indicators update via scroll listener on the scroller element.
HeroFlipbook	`hero-flipbook.tsx`	Yes	Archive — scroll-driven stacked-card flipbook hero (Obsidian Assembly pattern). No longer on the live homepage; still used by `/home-1`. Mobile uses `svh`-based sticky + pixel-based transforms (computed from captured viewport height) to stay stable through iOS URL-bar retraction. Scroll-driven state updates gated by `activeIndexRef` to prevent per-frame re-renders.
VideoMoment	`video-moment.tsx`	Yes	"Meet AUWA" section: portrait video card + text. Desktop: side-by-side. Mobile: stacked.
AuwaVideoBlock	`auwa-video-block.tsx`	Yes	Full-width AUWA face video. Landscape desktop, square mobile. Auto-plays on visibility.
MicroSeason	`micro-season.tsx`	Yes	Displays current 72 micro-season with kanji.
ObfuscatedEmail	`obfuscated-email.tsx`	Yes	Bot-proof email display. Shows `user[at]domain` initially, reveals real `mailto:` link on click. Props: `user`, `domain`.

ImageFade	`image-fade.tsx`	Yes	Next.js `<Image>` wrapper that fades from opacity 0 → 1 over `DURATION.reveal` once pixels are painted. Used on the article hero AND all editorial card images (journal index, in-article image-pair / image-beside, continue-reading). Cache-guard on mount: `img.complete && naturalWidth > 0` flips `loaded` directly so cached images on revisits don't stay at opacity 0 (onLoad never fires for them). Inline `transition` re-specifies `transform` + `filter` alongside opacity so the global `a img { transition: transform 0.8s ... }` hover-zoom rule isn't wiped by the inline opacity transition.
FigureHook	`figure-hook.tsx`	Yes	Sitewide bottom peek strip inviting visitors to the figure edition waitlist. Mounted in `layout.tsx`. Hidden on teaser pages (`/store`, `/app`, `/book`) where a local signup is already primary. Appears after 600px scroll, fades out as a zero-height sentinel at the end of `<main>` enters the viewport (240px pre-footer margin so the handoff to the footer's "Quiet letters" block is gentle). Sentinel watches main-content-end, not the sticky footer directly — the footer is `sticky bottom-0` from page load and would register as intersecting at every scroll position.

API routes:

Route	Purpose
`/api/signup`	Creates Resend contact + sends welcome email. Accepts `{ email, source }`.
`/api/newsletter/send`	Sends newsletter to full audience. Accepts content JSON + secret token.

Email templates (in `src/emails/`, React Email components, not rendered on the website):

Template	Purpose
`welcome.tsx`	Auto-sent on signup. 4 variants based on source.
`newsletter.tsx`	Manual newsletter sends. Accepts heading, intro, articles array, hero image.

SEO

- Dynamic meta tags per page (title, description, OG image)
- Structured data (JSON-LD) for articles (Article schema)
- Sitemap auto-generated
- Canonical URLs
- Journal articles are the primary SEO asset — target long-tail keywords around Japanese philosophy, craft, seasonal living, awareness

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6. Build Approach

v0 / Stitch Prompt Ideas

Use v0.dev or Stitch to rapidly scaffold pages, then refine in Claude Code. Prompts should be specific and reference-heavy:

Homepage prompt: "Create a dark-mode editorial homepage inspired by Kinfolk magazine. Serif display typography (Cormorant), sans-serif navigation (Inter or similar). Full-width hero with atmospheric photography and large headline overlay. Below: a brand statement line centred with generous whitespace, then a 3-column asymmetric article card grid (varied card sizes, dark backgrounds, warm photography). Minimal footer with wordmark. Overall feel: Japanese luxury hospitality meets design magazine. Colour: near-black backgrounds (#0f0f14), off-white text (#dddde2), subtle yellow-green accent (#c4cc5a). Tailwind CSS."

Article page prompt: "Create a long-form article page with dark background. Full-width hero image with parallax. Large serif headline (Cormorant) centred below hero. Article body in a narrow column (max 680px) with generous line-height. Pull quotes in larger serif, centred. Full-width photography interspersed. Author block at bottom. Related article cards (2-3) below. Newsletter signup at end. Dark, atmospheric, editorial. Think Cereal magazine online."

Journal index prompt: "Create a magazine-style article index page with dark background. Page title in large serif. Filter row with category tags. Article cards in asymmetric grid — mix of large (spanning 2 columns) and standard cards. Each card: atmospheric image, serif headline, one-line excerpt, category badge. Hover: subtle scale and brightness shift. Kinfolk/Cereal aesthetic. Dark mode."

Build Timeline (Achievable in a Few Days)

Day 1: Scaffold + Homepage

- Set up Next.js 16 + Tailwind 4 + Sanity
- Scaffold homepage layout (v0/Stitch for initial structure, Claude Code for refinement)
- Configure fonts (Cormorant, Instrument Sans, Noto Sans JP)
- Implement colour system (OKLCH custom properties in Tailwind config)
- Homepage: header, hero, brand statement, article grid (with placeholder content), newsletter signup, footer

Day 2: Article Pages + Journal Index

- Journal article page template (the most important page)
- Journal index with category filtering
- Sanity content model for articles, categories, authors
- Sanity Studio configured with preview
- Responsive testing across breakpoints

Day 3: Remaining Pages + Polish

- App, Store, Book pre-launch pages (atmospheric, simple)
- About page
- Newsletter integration (Resend)
- Motion: scroll reveals, hover states, page transitions
- SEO: meta tags, OG images, structured data
- Performance optimisation, Lighthouse audit
- Deploy to Vercel, connect domain

Day 4: Content Population

- Populate initial journal articles (see Section 7)
- Final photography treatment and upload
- Cross-browser testing
- Soft launch

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7. Preparing Initial Articles (The Day-One Content Plan)

The website needs content on day one. An empty journal undermines the editorial positioning. Aim for 8-10 articles prepared and ready to publish at launch — a mix that showcases the four content territories (seasons, craft, travel, philosophy) and gives the site enough density to feel established.

Article Preparation Approach

Tom and Rieko can prepare ~10 articles in a focused day using this workflow:

1. **Select 10 topics** from the list below
2. **Gather photography** from Tom's 15+ year Japan catalogue (already shot, just needs selection and Lightroom treatment)
3. **Write first drafts** — Tom writes in brand voice, 800-1500 words per article. Some can be shorter (500-word seasonal reflections). Use Claude to help draft, then edit for voice and authenticity.
4. **Rieko reviews** for cultural accuracy and adds Japanese terms/context
5. **Apply photography treatment** (Lightroom "AUWA — Atmospheric" preset)
6. **Upload to Sanity** with metadata, hero images, categories, SEO descriptions

Suggested Initial Articles

Seasons (2-3 articles):

- "The Fifth Day" — An introduction to how Japan divides the year into 72 micro-seasons, and what it means to notice the world in five-day increments. Photography: seasonal Japan landscapes.
- "Seimei (清明): The Light Returns" — A seasonal essay tied to the current micro-season at launch. Atmospheric, personal, grounded in a specific place and moment in Japan.

Craft (2-3 articles):

- "The Knife Maker of Seki" — Profile of a craftsman Tom and Rieko met during their Monolise research. The story of a lifetime spent perfecting a single craft. Photography from the workshop visit.
- "Objects with Kokoro" — An essay on the philosophy of choosing lifetime objects over disposable ones. Why a hand-forged knife or a ceramic cup from a master artisan changes your relationship with daily life.
- "What Wabi-Sabi Actually Means" — Reclaiming the concept from Instagram aesthetics. What it means to find beauty in imperfection and impermanence, beyond the interiors trend.

Travel (2-3 articles):

- "Temple Mornings" — An atmospheric essay about the ritual of visiting Japanese temples at dawn. The silence, the light, the practice of being present. Photography: Tom's temple work.

- "The Onsen Lesson" — On the Japanese bathing culture and what it teaches about shared space, vulnerability, and attention. Not a guide — a reflection.

Philosophy (2-3 articles):

- "Everything Has Kokoro" — The foundational essay. An accessible introduction to Yaoyorozu no Kami and why it matters in modern life. The philosophical anchor for the entire journal.
- "Awareness, Not Mindfulness" — Why AUWA uses the word "awareness" instead of "mindfulness." The difference between a Western self-help concept and a Japanese philosophical worldview.
- "The Guest" — On being a respectful visitor to Japan (and to any culture). The awareness that comes from understanding you are in someone else's home. Photography: Japan travel moments.

Content Calendar (Post-Launch)

After the initial 10 articles, publish 1-2 articles per week aligned with the 72 micro-seasons content calendar. Each micro-season (5 days) is an opportunity for a seasonal essay, craftsman profile, or travel piece. This gives the journal a natural rhythm without feeling forced.

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8. Newsletter & Email

Fully documented in `context/marketing/newsletter.md`. Summary:

- **Welcome emails** auto-send on signup (4 variants per source: newsletter, app-waitlist, store-waitlist, book-waitlist). Sent as transactional via `resend.emails.send()`. Unsubscribe is a plain `mailto:hello@auwa.life?subject=Unsubscribe` because the `{{{RESEND_UNSUBSCRIBE_URL}}}` merge var does not substitute in transactional sends.
- **Welcome email subjects**: "Welcome to AUWA" (newsletter) · "You're on the AUWA App waitlist" (app) · "A note from AUWA." (store and book — softer subject keeps them out of Gmail Promotions).
- **Newsletter sends** go through Resend's **Broadcasts API** (`resend.broadcasts.create()` + `.send()`), not the transactional Emails API. This is what enables the `{{{RESEND_UNSUBSCRIBE_URL}}}` merge variable and the `List-Unsubscribe` header. Triggered manually via the `/marketing:newsletter` slash command or the `/api/newsletter/send` endpoint.
- **Signup points**: shared footer on every page ("Quiet letters."), plus dedicated forms on app/store/book teaser pages
- **Templates**: React Email components in `src/emails/` (welcome.tsx, newsletter.tsx)
- **Resend segments**: App Waitlist, Store Waitlist, Book Waitlist (3 segments, free plan limit). Newsletter subscribers go to audience without a segment.
- **Subject format**: `[Topic] | AUWA` — poetic, not clickbait

Social share previews (journal articles)

Each article has a dedicated 1200×630 landscape OG image at `/journal/{slug}/{slug}-og.jpg`, alongside the portrait 4:5 hero. `generateMetadata()` in `src/app/journal/[slug]/page.tsx` derives the OG path from the hero filename. FB, Pinterest, and X pull this image into their link previews. Instagram is intentionally not supported — IG has no link-share flow. To regenerate after a hero change:

```
cd website/main/public/journal/{slug} && cp {slug}-hero.jpg {slug}-og.jpg && \
  sips --resampleWidth 1200 {slug}-og.jpg && sips -c 630 1200 {slug}-og.jpg
```

---

9. Analytics & Performance

- **Vercel Analytics** — installed and live. `@vercel/analytics/react` in `layout.tsx`. Privacy-respecting, no cookie consent banner needed.
- **Key metrics:** Page views, unique visitors, time on page (especially journal articles), newsletter signups (conversion rate by page), referral sources
- **Lighthouse target:** 95+ across all categories
- **Core Web Vitals:** LCP < 2.5s, FID < 100ms, CLS < 0.1

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10. Awwwards Submission Checklist

Baked in from the April 2026 SOTD-prep pass. CLAUDE.md carries the full list of learnings; this section is the quick site-level audit before any submission.

- Branded `src/app/not-found.tsx` renders for any unmatched URL (test with `/definitely-not-a-page`).
- Every dynamic slug route (`/journal/[slug]`) calls `notFound()` for unknown slugs AND exports `generateStaticParams` + `dynamicParams = false`. Never fall through to a fallback article.
- Draft / archive / internal routes (`/home-1` , `/book/1` , `/book/2` , `/brand` , `/instagram`) are noindex'd via metadata AND disallowed in `src/app/robots.ts`.
- `src/app/manifest.ts` exists with name, theme_color, icons. Both `favicon.svg` and `apple-touch-icon.png` present.
- Every top-level route exports its own `openGraph.images` + `twitter.images` at 1200×630. OG files under `public/og/{page}.jpg`. Article OGs live at `public/journal/{slug}/{slug}-og.jpg` — the `write-article` command now covers generation.
- All site imagery uses `next/image` (including inside horizontal scrollers with `loading="eager"` and `priority={i < 2}` on the first two cards — the default lazy-load heuristic misses off-viewport-right cards on iOS).
- `globals.css` has a `:focus-visible` ring. No component strips it with `outline-none` without an explicit replacement.
- Icon-only buttons carry `aria-label` ; decorative inline SVG gets `aria-hidden="true"` .
- `SoundToggle` inverts over the dark footer via IntersectionObserver, and pauses on `visibilitychange` + `pagehide` .
- `EditorialFrames` auto-advance is gated on an IO one-shot so rotation only starts when the module enters the viewport — first-time visitors see pillar 01 / Store first.

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